



Henri Matisse, *The Dance* (1910)

PSYCHOSOCIAL RESEARCH ROUNDS

Embodying Change: defrosting ageism through shared creative moments of perplexity

Martina Padovani, MSc

School of Physical and Occupational Therapy, McGill University

Session chaired by Vincent Paquin, MD

June 18, 2026

2:00 PM – 2:30 PM (ET)

Amphitheatre (ICFP), 4333 Côte-St-Catherine Rd., Montreal QC H3T 1E4

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Learning objectives

- Examine how participatory ethnography and immersive interview methods can surface first-person, embodied experiences of aging among Black older adults that standardized tools structurally miss.
- Explore how creative practices such as dance and pinhole photography, function as legitimate knowledge entry points for transcultural research with racialized communities.
- Reflect on researcher reflexivity as a methodological and ethical necessity when working across cultural differences with older adult populations.

Martina Padovani, MSc is a psychologist and PhD student at the School of Physical and Occupational Therapy at McGill University. Her work is grounded in participatory and ethnographic approaches to understanding the lived experience of aging among Black older adults in Montréal. In partnership with the Jamaica Association of Montréal (JAM), her current SSHRC-funded project uses immersive interview methodology: including binaural audio recordings, dance, and pinhole photography, to access embodied sensations and memories beyond what verbal interviews alone can reach. Her research advances culturally responsive methods and challenges ageist assumptions embedded in both research practice and clinical care.



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